Lourenz Baliber, MSc

CONTACT-CENTER FORECASTING & STAFFING

lbaliber0828@gmail.com
loubaliber.github.io/services
Cebu City, Philippines

CASE STUDY · CLIENT DETAILS WITHHELD

Planning staff for a support team whose volume was falling

A consumer retail support team needed a year-ahead contact forecast and a staffing plan. Figures and charts are indexed and altered to protect the client; no real volumes, dates or names are shown.

5 in 6
normal weeks forecast within 10%, one week ahead

Monthly
reissue, because accuracy drops further out

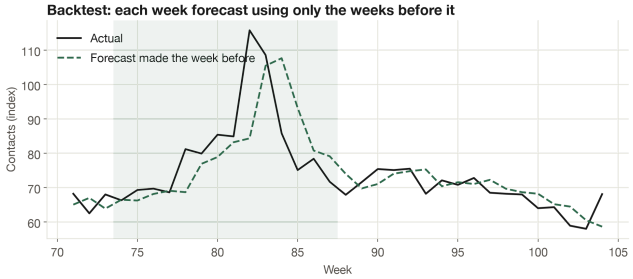
2–3×
baseline capacity to plan for the holiday peak

The problem

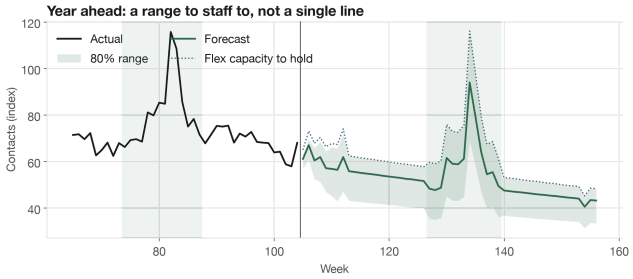
Weekly contacts had been falling steadily for two years, with a sharp surge every holiday season. Staffing from last year's numbers meant paying for agents the work no longer needed, and still being caught short in December.

What I did

- **Checked the data first:** two-plus years of weekly counts, checked for gaps and for channels adding up to totals. One feed started late, so it was treated as a break, not growth.
- **Chose the model by backtest only:** several methods, each refit every week and scored only on weeks it had not seen. Damped Holt was chosen.
- **Tested a tempting shortcut and dropped it:** using sales as a predictor looked better on past data but made unseen weeks noticeably worse.
- **Gave ranges, not one line:** simulated paths give an 80% band, plus a flex level to hold in reserve.
- **Turned contacts into agents** for every week.



Each week forecast using only the weeks before it.



Year ahead: a forecast, an 80% range and a flex level.

Results, including the limits

- One week ahead, the forecast was within 10% in about **five of every six** normal weeks. Eight weeks ahead it was about **one in three**, so the plan is reissued every month.
- For the full year, the total landed within a wide band across test starting points. The year figure is for budgeting, not for rostering.
- The holiday peak week needs about **twice** the agents of an average week, so the plan sets aside flexible capacity rather than permanent hires.

Want the same check on your forecast? Send 12 months or more of weekly contact volume. Within a week I'll backtest your current forecast against mine and show the staffing gap in hours and dollars. Free, under NDA.